

***Ink^h*: An uncompetitive pronoun in Eastern Armenian**

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1 Introduction

A central question regarding pronouns is how speakers know which antecedent a pronoun can refer to, and what constraints govern reference. For example, how does a speaker of English interpret *him* or *himself* in a sentence as (28)?

- (1) John_i saw him_{*i/j}/himself_{i/*j}.

For constraints, an early influential theory is the Binding Theory (BT), which suggests two conditions that syntactically constrain the reference of anaphors and pronominals (Chomsky 1986):

- (2) Condition A: An anaphor must be bound in its binding domain
(3) Condition B: A pronoun must be free in its binding domain.

This theory predicts that in English the pronominal *him* cannot refer to the local antecedent John in (28), while the reflexive *himself* must refer to it. Such a pattern of referential behavior of pronominals and reflexives holds not only in English but also for other languages, such as related languages (e.g., Germanic languages) and non-related languages (e.g., Chinese). However, this paper shows that the same cannot be argued for the pronouns in Standard Eastern Armenian (SEA).

There are three critical pronominal elements – *ink^h*, *ink^hn iren* and *na* – that I will consider in this paper. The pronoun *ink^h* in SEA can have both bound anaphoric reading and free reading in the local binding domain. For example, in (4) *ink^h* can refer to the local subject Ani or a third person different from Ani.

- (4) Ani-n_i tesav iren_{i/j}
Ani:NOM-DEF saw ink^h:3SG:ACC
'Ani saw her (him)' OR 'Ani saw herself'

Contrarily, the pronoun *na* must be free in the local domain. For example in (5) the pronoun *na* refers to an antecedent that must be different from Ani.

- (5) Ani-n_i tesav nran_{*i/j}
Ani:NOM-DEF saw na:3SG:ACC
'Ani saw her (him)'

Finally, the reflexive *ink^hn iren* must be bound as shown in (6):

- (6) Ani-n_i tesav ink^hn iren_{i/*j}
Ani:NOM-DEF saw ink^hn ink^h:3SG:ACC
'Ani saw herself'

An immediate question arises regarding how and why *ink^h* can have both anaphoric and free interpretations in the same local domain. If we consider *ink^h* as a pronoun then why can it get an anaphoric meaning and not be blocked by the reflexive? On the other hand, if it is an anaphor then why does it have the free interpretation? A goal of this paper is to clarify the status of *ink^h* – whether it is an (exempt) anaphor or a pronoun and explain its behavior in (4). As an empirical basis, I will consider Eastern and Western dialects of Armenian. This paper shows that *ink^h* is a non-defective, syntactically simple pronoun that can have also anaphoric reading. Furthermore, I show that *ink^h* is not subject to BT principles due to the absence of full grammaticalizations (akin Cole *et al.*) of these principles in Eastern Armenian but it is a subject of BT principles in Western Armenian, where these principles are fully grammaticalized.

This paper is organized as follows: in the next section, I will give a detailed background on the three pronouns in SEA and describe the pattern considering simple and complex structures. The third section is dedicated to the discussion of the pattern observed in SEA considering theoretical frameworks as *exempt anaphors* (Charnavel & Zlogar 2015), *reflexivity* (Reinhart & Reuland 1993; Reuland 2011; Reuland & Volkova 2014; Reuland 2016), *competition* (Safir *et al.* 2004). The fourth section presents the proposal arguing that the uncompetitiveness of *ink^h* is related to the grammaticalization of the BT constraints in the language.

2 Background on *ink^h*, *ink^hn iren* and *na*

This section provides a detailed description of the referential properties of three pronominal elements – *ink^h*, *ink^hn iren* and *na*. The pronouns of interest are all third-person pronouns and they do not refer to first or second person antecedents:

- (7) Yes_i tesa iren_{*i}/ nran_{*i}/ ink^hn iren_{*i}
 I see:PRV:1SG ink^h:ACC/ na:ACC/ ink^h ink^h:ACC
 Intended: ‘I saw myself’
- (8) Du_i tesar iren_{*i}/ nran_{*i}/ ink^hn iren_{*i}
 you see:PRV:2SG ink^h:ACC/ na:ACC/ ink^h ink^h:ACC
 Intended: ‘You saw yourself’

In terms of features, pronouns are marked for number and case, which is determined by their syntactic position. Gender is not a marked feature in the language, thus there is not gender marking on pronouns either.

2.1 *Ink^h*

Ink^h is a case and number-sensitive pronoun and appears with different morphological forms on the surface depending on the case and the syntactic position in a sentence. Table 1 summarizes the morphological distribution for *ink^h* for different cases and numbers.

In terms of its referential properties *ink^h* gets both free and bound reading in the local domain regardless of whether its antecedent is a quantificational expression or a referential expression.

Case	Singular <i>ink^h</i>	Plural <i>ink^h</i>
NOM	ink ^h	irenk ^h
GEN	ir	irenc
ACC	iren	irenc
DAT	iren	irenc
ABL	irenic	irencic
INST	irenov	irencov
LOC	irenum	irencum

Table 1: Case forms of *ink^h*

(9) *Local domain: coargument*

Aram- Θ_i tesav iren_{i/j}
Aram::NOM-DEF see:PRV:3SG ink^h:ACC
‘Aram saw him/himself.’

(10) *Quantificational antecedent: coargument*

[Yuraqanchyur axjik]_i iren_{i/j} e sir-um
Every girl ink^h:ACC be:3SG like-IMPRF
‘Every girl likes herself/her.’

The same pattern holds for the cases when *ink^h* is not a coargument by itself but part of it.

(11) *Possessor inside a coargument*

Aram- Θ_i kardac’ ir_{i/j} girq- Θ
Aram:NOM-DEF read:PRV:3SG ink^h:GEN book:ACC-DEF
Means: ‘Aram read someone else’s book OR ‘Aram read his own book’

Furthermore, *ink^h* can have an antecedent that does not c-command it. For example, in (12) it can refer to *sister*, that c-commands it, but also to Aram that does not.

(12) Aram_i-i k^hujr_j- Θ kardac’ ir_{i/j} girk^h- Θ
Aram-GEN sister:NOM-DEF read:PRV ink^h:GEN book:ACC-DEF
‘Aram’s sister read his (i.e., Aram’s) book’ OR ‘Aram’s sister read her (i.e., sister’s) book.’

Additionally, it can refer to an antecedent out of the clause. For example, in (13) *ink^h* can refer to the local subject Ani as well as to the embedded subject Aram.

(13) *Embedded clause*

Aram- Θ_i karc-um e vor Ani-n_j iren_{i/j}
Aram:NOM-DEF think-IMPRF be:3SG that Ani:NOM-DEF ink^h:ACC
e sir-um
be:3SG like-IMPRF
‘Aram thinks that Ani likes him/herself’

Ink^h can also be in the subject position and establish cross-sentential reference not being limited to the local clause. For example, in (31) *ink^h* can refer to the subject of the previous sentence, i.e., Aram, or the object, i.e., Ani:

- (14) Aram_i-ə handipeç' Ani_j-in. Ink^h-ə_{i/j} gradaran er
 Aram:NOM-DEF meet:PRV Ani-DAT. ink^h:NOM-DEF library be:PST.3SG
 gn-um
 go-IMPRF
 'Aram met Ani. He was going to the library.' OR 'Aram met Ani. She was going to the library.'

In the VP ellipsis, both sloppy and strict readings are available for *ink^h*. As illustrated in (15) there are three possible interpretations available:

- (15) *VP ellipsis*
 Aram-n_i at-um e iren_{i/j/k}, Vahan-n_j el.
 Aram:NOM-DEF hate-IMPF AUX ink^h:ACC Vahan:NOM-DEF too.
 'Aram hate him(self), Vahan too'
 a. Aram hates Aram, Vahan hates Vahan.
 b. Aram hates Aram, Vahan hates Aram.
 c. Aram hates Sargis, Vahan hates Sargis.

Summing up, the pronoun *ink^h* can behave as a free pronominal element and be disjoint from the local antecedent but also can behave as an anaphor and be bound locally.

2.2 Ink^hn iren

Ink^hn iren is a morphologically complex reflexive pronoun that consists of two *ink^h*s as shown in (17). The first morpheme is unmarked, nominative form and the second part is the accusative marked *ink^h*.¹

- (16) ink^h-n iren
 ink^h:NOM-DEF ink^h:ACC

In the case of *ink^hn iren* only the second morpheme is sensitive to the case and its morphology changes depending on its syntactic position. For the whole pattern of the morphological changes refer to Table 1. It is worth mentioning that for the *ink^hn iren* a nominative form does not exist:²

¹In the examples I will gloss *ink^hn iren* as ink^h ink^h:CASE, where I will specified the features for the second morpheme but not for the first morpheme. This decision is based on the fact that the first morpheme does not change, so I will keep the glossing as simple as possible.

²The literature on complex reflexives and reciprocals reported that cross-linguistically it is a common pattern that they copy the case feature from the antecedent (Messick & Harðarson 2024; Messick & Raghotham 2021). In such constructions, one morpheme of the complex reflexive pronoun copies the case feature of its antecedent, while the case of the second morpheme is determined by its syntactic position. Instances of case-copying reflexives have been documented in various languages, including Icelandic and Telugu (see Messick & Harðarson 2024; Messick & Raghotham

- (17) *ink^h-n ink^h
 ink^h:NOM-DEF ink^h:NOM

In terms of its referential properties, as a reflexive pronoun, *ink^hn iren* must be bound in the local domain and it cannot get a free pronominal reading:

- (18) *Local domain: coargument*
 Aram-ə_i tesav ink^hn iren_{i/*j}
 Aram:NOM-DEF see:PRV:3SG ink^h ink^h:ACC
 ‘Aram saw himself.’
- (19) *Quantificational antecedent: coargument*
 [Yuraqanchyur axjik]_i ink^hn iren_{i/*j} e sir-um
 Every girl ink^h ink^h:ACC be:3SG like-IMPRF
 ‘Every girl likes herself.’
- (20) *Possessor inside a coargument*
 ?Aram-ə_i kardac’ ink^hn ir_{i/*j} girq-ə
 Aram:NOM-DEF read:PRV:3SG ink^h ink^h:GEN book:ACC-DEF
 ‘Aram read his own book.’

As a reflexive pronoun *ink^hn iren* cannot have an antecedent that does not c-command it. In the example (21) the only possible antecedent for it is *sister*, that c-commands it.

- (21) Aram_i-i k^hujrj-ə kardac’ ink^hn ir_{*i/j} girk^h-ə
 Aram-GEN sister:NOM-DEF read:PRV ink^h ink^h:GEN book:ACC-DEF
 ‘Aram’s sister read her (i.e., sister’s) book.’

Unlike to *ink^h*, *ink^hn iren* is restricted by a local clause and cannot refer to an antecedent outside of the clause:

- (22) *Embedded clause*
 Aram-ə_i karc-um e vor Ani-n_j ink^hn iren_{*i/j}
 Aram:NOM-DEF think-IMPRF be:3SG that Ani:NOM-DEF ink^h ink^h:ACC
 e sir-um
 be:3SG like-IMPRF

2021).

However, *ink^hn iren* does not exhibit case-copying behavior. Specifically, the first morpheme, *ink^h*, does not replicate the case feature of its antecedent. Evidence for this claim arises from ditransitive structures, where *ink^hn iren* can have two potential antecedents: a nominative-marked subject or an accusative-marked object. Notably, the case marking on the first morpheme remains unchanged, regardless of the case of the antecedent.

- (1) Aram_i-n Ani_j-in tvec’ ink^hn ir_{i/j} girk^h-ə
 Aram:NOM-DEF Ani-DAT give:PRV ink^h ink:GEN book:ACC-DEF
 Aram gave Ani his/her book’

‘Aram thinks that Ani likes herself’

Cross-clausal reference is not possible for *ink^hn iren*, since it cannot be in a subject position. The subject position requires nominative marking and for the reflexive *ink^hn iren* nominative form does not exist.

- (23) Aram_i-ə handipec’ Ani_j-in. *ink^hn inkə....
 Aram:NOM-DEF meet:PRV Ani-DAT. ink^h ink^h:NOM

Finally, as it can be predicted from this pattern, in the VP ellipsis only the sloppy reading is available for *ink^hn iren*:

- (24) *VP ellipsis*
 Aram-n_i at-um e ink^hn iren_{i/*j/*k}, Vahan-n_j el.
 Aram:NOM-DEF hate-IMPF AUX ink^h ink^h:ACC Vahan:NOM-DEF too.
 ‘Aram hates himself, Vahan too.’
 a. Vahan hates himself.
 b. *Vahan hates Aram.
 c. *Vahan hates Sargis.

Thus, the reflexive *ink^hn iren* must be bound locally and in fact, it is restricted to a local clause only.

2.3 Na

The pronoun *na* is derived from demonstrative pronouns and in Armenian is used as a personal pronoun (Acharian 1957). Similar to *ink^h*, *na* has morphological sensitivity to number and case marking depending on its syntactic position. Table 2 summarizes the morphological distribution of *na* for case and number:

Case	Singular <i>na</i>	Plural <i>na</i>
Nom	na	nranq
Gen	nra	nranc
Acc	nran	nranc
Dat	nran	nranc
Abl	nranic	nrancic
Inst	nranov	nrancov
Loc	nranum	nrancum

Table 2: Case forms of *na*

Na behaves as a free pronoun and in the local domain it cannot refer to a local antecedent.

(25) *Local domain: coargument*

Aram-ə_i tesav nran-_{i/j}
 Aram:NOM-DEF see:PRV:3SG na:ACC
 ‘Aram saw him.’

(26) *Quantificational antecedent: coargument*

[Yuraqanchyur axjik]_i nran-_{i/j} e sir-um
 Every girl na:ACC be:3SG like-IMPRF
 ‘Every girl likes her.’

Interestingly, *na* cannot refer to the local subject even if it is a possessor inside a coargument, a pattern that in some languages, e.g., English, is acceptable (cf (27) and (28)).

(27) *Possessor inside a coargument*

Aram-ə_i kardac’ nra-_{i/j} girq-ə
 Aram:NOM-DEF read:PRV:3SG na:GEN book:ACC-DEF
 Means: ‘Aram read someone else’s book.’

(28) Dave read his book.

Similar to *ink^h*, *na* allows reference to an antecedent that does not c-command it. In this respect it is in complementary distribution with the reflexive *ink^hn iren*. In the example (29) *na* can refer to Aram, but not to *sister*:

(29) Aram-_i-i k^hujr-ə kardac’ nra-_{i/*j} girk^h-ə
 Aram-GEN sister:NOM-DEF read:PRV na:GEN book:ACC-DEF
 ‘Aram’s sister read his (i.e., Aram’s) book.’

Na can refer to an antecedent out of the clause. For example, in (30) it can refer to the embedded subject Aram or any other contextually available antecedent that is different from the local subject Ani.

(30) *Embedded clause*

Aram-ə_i karc-um e vor Ani-n_j nran-_{i/*j/k} e
 Aram:NOM-DEF think-IMPRF be:3SG that Ani:NOM-DEF na:ACC be:3SG
 sir-um
 like-IMPRF
 ‘Aram thinks that Ani likes him.’

As in the case of *ink^h*, *na* can be in the subject position and establish cross-sentential reference not being limited to the local clause. For example, in (31) it can refer to the subject of the previous sentence, i.e., Aram, or the object, i.e., Ani:³

³When the word order of the preceding sentence is SOV, there is a preference to use *ink^h* for the subject reference and *na* for object reference. When the word order is changed to OSV, then the strong preference goes away. For more discussion on this I will refer the reader to an experimental study on *ink^h* and *na* by Asatryan 2022.

- (31) Aram_i-ə handipeç' Ani_j-in. Na_{i/j} gradaran er
 Aram:NOM-DEF meet:PRV Ani-DAT. ink^h:NOM library be:PST.3SG
 gn-um
 go-IMPRF
 'Aram met Ani. He was going to the library.' OR 'Aram met Ani. She was going to the library.'

In the VP ellipsis, only a strict reading is available in the case of *na*:

- (32) *VP ellipsis*
 Aram-n_i at-um e nran_{*i/*j/k}, Vahan-n_j el.
 Aram:NOM-DEF hate-IMPF AUX na:ACC Vahan:NOM-DEF too.
 'Aram hates him, Vahan too.'
 a. *Vahan hates himself.
 b. *Vahan hates Aram.
 c. Vahan hates Sargis.

Summing up the pattern for the three pronouns of interest, *na* and *ink^hn iren* are subject to BT conditions and the first must be free in the local domain, while the latter must be bound in the local domain. As summarized in 33, *na* and *ink^hn iren* are in complementary distribution. Contrarily, *ink^h* can behave both as an anaphor and a free pronoun in the same local domain and it is not restricted by any constraint.

- (33) Referential properties of *ink^h*, *na* and *ink^hn iren*

	<i>ink^h</i>	<i>na</i>	<i>ink^hn iren</i>
Can be bound in the local domain	✓	✗	✓
Can be free in the local domain	✓	✓	✗
Can refer to a non-local antecedent	✓	✓	✗
Is insensitive to c-command	✓	✓	✗
Can have cross-sentential reference	✓	✓	✗

The question is what is *ink^h*. Is it an anaphor that is exempt from Condition A, or a pronoun that is not subject to Condition B? Next I will turn to the discussion of the status of *ink^h*.

3 Is it a pronoun or an anaphor?

Considering the BT, there are two possible hypotheses for the status of *ink^h*:

- (34) *Hypothesis 1*: *ink^h* is an exempt anaphor (in sense of Charnavel & Zlogar 2015).
 (35) *Hypothesis 2*: *ink^h* is a pronoun that can be exempt from Condition B.

In this section, I examine both hypotheses and show that *ink^h* is a pronoun that can violate Condition B.

3.1 *Ink^h* is not an (exempt) anaphor

Starting with the first hypothesis in (34), let's consider *ink^h* as an anaphor that can be exempt from Condition A. Such anaphor can have a non-local antecedent but only if the non-local antecedent has special properties such as being an *attitude holder*, *empathy loci*, or *deictic center* (Charnavel & Zlogar 2015).

Indeed, *ink^h* can have a non-local antecedent that is an attitude holder. For example, in (36) *ink^h* can refer to the attitude holder *Aram*. However, in (36) *ink^h* also can refer to *Ani* which is not the attitude holder.

- (36) Aram-n_i asac Ani-in_j vor ink^h_{i/j} hravirvac' e xnjuyk^h_i
 Aram:NOM-DEF said Ani-ACC that ink invited be:3SG party
 'Aram said to Ani that she/he is invited to the party.'

Additionally, *ink^h* can have a non-local antecedent that is an empathy locus, but, again, it also can have a different antecedent. For example, *ink^h* can refer to Ani in (37) but also can refer to Ani in (38), where Ani is not the empathy loci. Examples (37) and (38) are adopted from Charnavel & Zlogar (2015).

- (37) Ir_i masin ananun namak-ə xoc'ec' Ani-i_i zgacmunq-ner-ə
 ink^h:GEN about anonymous letter-DEF hurt Ani-GEN feeling-PL-DEF
 'The anonymous letter about herself hurt Ani's feelings'
 (38) Ir_i masin ananun namak-ə vnasec' Ani-i_i hexinakutyan-ə
 ink^h:GEN about anonymous letter-DEF hurt Ani-GEN popularity-DEF
 'The anonymous letter about herself hurt Ani's popularity'

Given that, *ink^h* can be free in the local domain, have a non-local antecedent that is not necessary attitude holder, empathy loci, I argue that *ink^h* is a pronoun rather than an anaphor.

3.2 *Ink^h* as a pronoun

In this section, we will investigate the second hypothesis, considering *ink^h* as a pronoun. The main challenge is to understand why it does not obey Condition B.

The observation that a pronoun can get both anaphoric and pronominal interpretations in the local domain is not new. Similar cases are known from Frisian (Everaert 1986), Romanian (Ivan 2020), Khanty (Reuland & Volkova 2014) and Jambi (Cole *et al.* 2015).

In this section, I will consider several theories that have been proposed for exempt pronouns.

3.2.1 Reuland, 2016: Unity vs diversity

Reuland (2016) in his response to Cole et al (2015) study on Indonesian languages points to certain aspects of BT that need to be emphasized when dealing with a pronoun that can violate Condition B.⁴ The first important point is the *Licensing reflexivity*:

⁴ Reuland 2016 is built on some earlier works as Reinhart & Reuland 1993, Reinhart 1983, Reuland 2011, Reuland & Volkova 2014.

- (39) *Licensing reflexivity*: reflexivity must be licensed either by semantics when the predicate is lexically reflexive, or in the syntax when one of the arguments is reflexive marked by a *self-pronoun*. (Reuland 2016)

An example of a semantic licensing of reflexivity can be observed in the case of self-oriented verbs as *to wash*, *to shave*. These verbs are lexically reflexive and thus, reflexivity is licensed by the semantics of these predicates. In the case of transitive verbs such as *to see* in order to license reflexivity, one of the arguments should be marked by a *self-pronoun*.

- (40) John shaved.
(41) John saw himself.

The second point that needs to be highlighted is the Chain condition:

- (42) *Chain condition*: Only the highest element in a syntactic dependency (a “chain”) can be fully specified for syntactic features. (Reuland 2016)

The *Chain condition* implies that in languages such as English, the pronoun *him/her* cannot be bound by the local antecedent because they both are fully specified for syntactic features. The linguistic algorithm of reference cannot handle featurally fully realised and identical expressions in a local domain (due to the Inability to Distinguish Indistinguishables, IDI, Reuland 2011).

Finally, as a last point, it is important to check the morpho-syntactic features of a pronoun under discussion considering the *Morphosyntactic featural constraint*:

- (43) *Morphosyntactic featural constraint*: Syntactic binding of pronominal elements (including anaphors) in a particular environment is determined by their morphosyntactic features and the way these enter into the syntactic operations available in that environment (Reuland 2016).

The importance of *Morphosyntactic featural constraint* comes into play when a pronoun can violate Condition B. If a pronoun is defective considering its syntactic features then it can create a dependency on the local antecedent without violating the *Chain condition*. On the other hand, a pronoun can be morphologically complex entailing syntactic complexity that will make the pronoun invisible for the *Chain condition*. A common strategy cross-linguistically is to add a body part morpheme or *self* to the pronoun and make its morphosyntactic features invisible for the *Chain condition*. For example, *self* in English is a such protector for *him* in *himself*.

- (44) John saw *himself*.

Under the second hypothesis considering *ink^h* as a pronoun, the relevant question is how it violates Condition B. Can it license reflexivity and if it is how?

In terms of reflexivity, in Armenian, the semantic licensing of reflexivity is done by bundling and the syntactic licensing by a reflexive pronoun. The examples (45) and (46) illustrate the semantic strategy of licensing the reflexivity, where the verbal predicate is marked reflexive. The syntactic strategy of licensing the reflexivity is done by having the reflexive pronoun *ink^hn iren* as one of the arguments, illustrated in (47).

- (45) Aram-ə sapr-ec' Ashot-in
 Aram-NOM shave-PRV Ashot:ACC
 'Aram shaved Ashot'
- (46) Aram-ə sapr-v-ec'
 Aram-NOM shave-REF-PRV
 'Aram shaved (himself)'
- (47) Aram-ə sapr-ec' ink^hn iren
 Aram-NOM shave-PRV ink^h ink^h:ACC
 'Aram shaved (himself)'
- (48) *Aram-ə sapr-v-ec' ink^hn iren
 Aram-NOM shave-REF-PRV ink^h ink^h:ACC
 Intended: 'Aram shaved (himself)'

Ink^h also can be used to license reflexivity syntactically when the predicate is not marked reflexive.

- (49) Aram-ə sapr-ec' iren
 Aram-NOM shave-PRV ink^h:ACC
 'Aram shaved (himself)'
- (50) *Aram-ə sapr-v-ec' iren
 Aram-NOM shave-REF-PRV ink^h:ACC
 Intended: 'Aram shaved (himself)'

Under the hypothesis of considering *ink^h* a pronoun, (49) should be possible only if *ink^h* is defective and can create a dependency. However, as was shown above *ink^h* has fully realized features and is inflected for number and case. Furthermore, it can have both a quantification and a non-quantificational antecedent. Additionally, it is a morphologically simple element without any additional complexity that could make it invisible for the *Chain condition*. Thus, *ink^h* can license reflexivity violating the *Chain condition*.

3.2.2 Competition account

According to competition-based theories, the pronoun gets a free reading in the local domain due to the competition between a more specific element, i.e., reflexive, and a less specific element, i.e., a pronoun (Safir *et al.* 2004). Consequently, if a pronoun can refer to a local antecedent, then the competing reflexive is defective and cannot compete. Thus, a possible prediction for the SEA would be that the reflexive pronoun might be defective and so cannot compete with the pronoun *ink^h*.

However, this hypothesis easily can be falsified by looking at the behavior of the reflexive *ink^hn iren* described above. It must be bound locally and importantly, blocks the bound reading for the pronoun *na*. Furthermore, it is fully specified for features and there is not any reason to consider it as a defective element. This suggests that in SEA a morphologically simple, non-defective pronoun *ink^h* does not compete with a non-defective reflexive pronoun and can get both anaphoric and

a free reading in the same local domain.⁵ Next, I will turn to the proposal, by exploring why *ink^h* is not subject to BT conditions.

4 Proposal

In this paper, I propose that the phenomenon observed in SEA is connected to the grammaticalization process of BT conditions in the language. In this respect, I consider the grammaticalization approach proposed by Cole *et al.* 2015.

4.1 Grammaticalisation approach

Cole *et al.* (2015) argued that from a cross-linguistic perspective, the direction of development appears to be consistently from a functionally based system to a more rigid system. They state that this development goes through three stages:

- (51) Stages in the grammaticalization of anaphora
- a. **Stage 1:** bare pronouns are undifferentiated anaphors (local coreference and non-coreference possible); the likelihood of Binding Theoretic reflexive interpretation is higher when an intensifier is present.
 - b. **Stage 2:** anaphor + intensifier interpreted as Binding Theoretic reflexive but simple bare pronoun can be interpreted as either reflexive or pronoun.
 - c. **Stage 3:** bare pronoun is interpreted only as a Binding Theoretic pronoun.

This proposal is based on a synchronic investigation of three dialects of Jambi – Traditional Jambi Malay (TJM), Pranakan Javanese, and Jambi City Malay (JCM). The claim about the grammaticalization process is based on the fact that the preferred interpretations of pronouns in TJM are fixed rules in JCM. They observed that in TJM the bare pronoun *dio/dio?* and pronoun+intensifier (*dio? dewe?*) both get free reading and reflexive reading in a local domain. In this respect, TJM pronouns are not subject to BT conditions. Crucially in TJM, there is a tendency to give reflexive interpretation to the pronoun+intensifier *dio?dewe?* and free interpretation to the bare pronoun *dio/dio?* in the local domain. Speakers prefer a local antecedent for a pronoun with the intensifier and a nonlocal antecedent for the bare pronoun. On the other hand, in JCM, the bare pronoun *dio/dio?* behaves as BT pronominal: it has free interpretation in the local binding domain, while the pronoun+intensifier (*dio? dewe?*) gets reflexive interpretation and, similar to reflexive pronouns, is bound locally. The free interpretation for the bare pronoun and the reflexive interpretation of pronoun+intensifier is part of the grammar of JCM. This fact makes JCM pronouns subject to BT conditions. Consequently, the grammatical rule of JCM that makes JCM pronouns subject to BT conditions, is a tendency in TJM. In sum, three varieties of Jambi correspond to different stages of grammaticalisation:

⁵Overall, the data provided in this paper forces to question what is the definition of a pronoun. Is it something that should be defined by Binding Theory (and by this, I mean any version of it) or does it go beyond it?

1. Traditional Jambi Malay (TJM) – Stage 1,
2. Pranakan Javanese – Stage 2,
3. Jambi City Malay (JCM) – Stage 3

Studies of the historical development of reflexives have shown that similar developments have occurred in the differentiation of reflexives and pronouns in many languages: reflexive interpretation of pronoun+intensifier was a tendency that eventually became a grammatical rule. A similar fact has been reported for English considering Old and Middle English and comparing it with Modern English (see Keenan 2008; König & Siemund 2000; König & Vezzosi 2004; Bergeton & Pancheva 2012; Bergeton 2004).

4.2 Grammaticalization in Western and Eastern Armenians

Considering two standard dialects of Armenian – Western and Eastern – we observe a similar situation.

As described above, the reflexive *ink^hn iren* consisted of two *ink^h*s. In Armenian *ink^h* is identical with the intensifier as shown in (52).⁶ Thus, it seems reasonable to consider the reflexive *ink^hn iren* as pronoun+intensifier.

- (52) Aram-n ink^h-ə champruk-ə bacec
 Aram-NOM ink^h:NOM-DEF suitcase-ACC open:AOR
 ‘Aram himself opened the suitcase’

From this angle, the pattern observed in SEA is very similar to the pattern in Pranakakan Javanese, i.e., the pronoun *ink^h* is an undifferentiated anaphor, while *ink^h* +intensifier is grammaticalized as the reflexive pronoun.

In contrast to SEA, in Standard Western Armenian (SWA) the pronoun *ink^h* is subject to the BT conditions and it cannot get an anaphoric reading in a local domain. In SWA only the reflexive *ink^hn iren* can be bound locally.

- (53) Aram-ə_i iren_{i/j} desav
 AramNOM-DEF ink^h:ACC ses:PRV
 ‘Aram saw him’ (SWA)
- (54) Aram-ə_i ink^hn iren_{i/*j} desav
 Aram:NOM-DEF ink^h ink^h:ACC see:PRV
 ‘Aram saw himself’ (SWA)

Thus, two standard dialects of Armenian correspond to two different grammaticalization stages. Eastern dialect corresponds to Stage 2, where the pronoun *ink^h* is exempt from Condition B and can get anaphoric use. Western dialect corresponds to the final stage of the grammaticalization process, where the pronoun *ink^h* is subject to Condition B and can get only a free reading in the binding domain.

Since grammaticalization is a continuous process, then this proposal predicts that in the Eastern dialect, we should also observe a tendency of preference *ink^hn*

⁶In this paper I will refrain from claiming that one is derived from another. Both the pronoun and the intensifier appear in Grabar (Classical Armenian) texts from the 5th century.

iren over *ink^h* in anaphoric use. Although in most cases both pronouns are used interchangeably, in causatives *ink^hn iren* is preferred for anaphora over *ink^h*.

- (55) #Aram-n amachec'r-ec' iren
 Aram-NOM shame:CAUS-PRV ink^h:ACC
 Intended: 'Aram ashamed himself'
- (56) Aram-n amachec'r-ec' ink^hn iren
 Aram-NOM shame:CAUS-PRV ink^h ink^h:ACC
 'Aram ashamed himself'

The pronoun *ink^h* can get an anaphoric reading in a causative sentence when it is focused prosodically:

- (57) Aram-n amachec'r-ec' iren'
 Aram-NOM shame:CAUS-PRV inq:ACC:FOC
 'Aram ashamed himself'

5 Conclusion

In this paper, I discussed the puzzling behavior of the pronoun *ink^h* in Armenian. I showed that the pronoun *ink^h* is a non-defective, syntactically simple pronoun that can get anaphoric reading, which excludes the direction of analysis proposed by reflexivity theory (e.g., Reuland 2016). The reflexive pronoun *ink^hn iren* is also not a defective reflexive pronoun and it behaves as Condition A will predict for a reflexive pronoun. This led to the exclusion of competition-based theories.

Comparing two standard varieties of Armenian, I showed that *ink^h* is subject to Condition B in SWA but not in SEA. This suggests that the two dialects are in different stages of grammaticalisation of BT conditions providing an argument for the grammaticalization approach (i.e., Cole *et al.* 2015).

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